

Parent Guide — primary / module-06- moon-phases-tithi

IKS Curriculum

Table of Contents

Parent Guide — Module 6: Moon Phases & Tithi (Primary)

Your child's age: Primary (Grades 3–5) · **Module length:** 10 sessions × 30 min over ~2 weeks

What your child is learning

Why the Moon changes shape — and that special names exist for the new-moon and full-moon nights.

Two Sanskrit words your child will know by the end: - *amāvasyā* — new moon (no Moon visible) - *pūrṇimā* — full moon (full round Moon)

Plus four anchor “tithi” names (a tithi is a “Moon-day”): *pratipadā* (first), *pañcamī* (fifth), *aṣṭamī* (eighth), *pūrṇimā* (full).

How we teach it

Through: - A torch-and-ball demo (Day 1) showing why the Moon changes shape. - A 10-night Moon diary, with simple sketches. - Stories — including an old Indian story about the Moon visiting its “house family” each night. - A sticker calendar each child makes as a project.

The framing is **observational** (“look up, look up, look up”) and **playful**.

Homework you'll see

- **Nightly Moon-watching** for 10 nights. Step outside for 30 seconds and look at the Moon together. Help your child draw what they see.
- That's pretty much it. We deliberately keep homework very light at this age.

How to help

Helpful: - Stand outside with your child for 30 seconds at night. Point at the Moon. Ask “what shape is it?” That's the whole assignment. - If it's cloudy, look up the Moon's phase on any free app or NASA's calendar. Show your child the predicted shape. - Talk about a festival in your family that happens on a specific Moon shape — Holī (*pūrṇimā*), Dīwālī (*amāvasyā*), Karva Cauth (waning Moon), etc.

Not helpful: - Drawing the Moon FOR your child. The wobbly shapes are the point. - Testing them on Sanskrit pronunciation. They'll get it from class repetition. - Sharing any complicated religious meanings of the Moon shapes. Save that for when they're older — at Primary band, the lesson is calendrical.

Safety — eclipses (very important)

NEVER let your child look directly at the Sun, including during a solar eclipse. This can cause permanent eye damage. If a solar eclipse occurs during this module: - ISO 12312-2 certified eclipse glasses are the only safe way to view directly. - Pinhole projection (project the Sun through a small hole onto paper) is safe and fun. - Ordinary sunglasses do NOT work. Smoked glass does NOT work. Photographic film does NOT work.

Lunar eclipses are safe to view directly. Your child can look at them.

We teach this in Day 7. Please reinforce at home.

What success looks like

By end of module, your child can: - Say the words *amāvasyā* (new moon) and *pūrṇimā* (full moon). - Tell you, in their own words, why the Moon changes shape (the Sun lights it up; we see different bits). - Show you their 10-night Moon-shape diary. - Show you their sticker-Moon calendar poster.

Going outside

The biggest thing you can give your child this module is the experience of standing outside one evening with you and looking at the Moon. Even once.

Want to go deeper?

Middle band (Grade 6–8) introduces tithis precisely (as 1/30 of a Moon cycle), the full 15 tithi names, eclipse geometry, and the festival calendar. Preview: [curriculum/middle/module-06-moon-phases-tithi/README.md](#).

10-Day Lesson Plan

Module 6 (Primary) — 10-Day Lesson Plan

At a glance

Day	Session title	Lesson file	What happens
1	The Moon Story	days/day-01-moon-story.md	Story + torch-and-ball demo
2	The Two Halves	days/day-02-two-halves.md	New moon, full moon, growing/shrinking

Day	Session title	Lesson file	What happens
3	The Moon's House Visits	days/day-03-house-visits.md	Folktale framing of the Moon's monthly journey
4	Drawing the Moon	days/day-04-drawing-the-moon.md	Each child draws 4 phases
5	The Four Tithi Friends	days/day-05-four-tithis.md	Naming pratipadā, pañcamī, aṣṭamī, pūrṇimā
6	Festivals and the Moon	days/day-06-festivals.md	Holī, Dīwālī, Karva Cauth — when do they happen?
7	Safety + the Moon Goes Dark	days/day-07-safety.md	Eclipse safety + brief “sometimes the Moon goes dark”
8	Make Your Moon Calendar	days/day-08-make-calendar.md	Sticker calendar project
9	Decorate and Practise	days/day-09-decorate.md	Project finishing + practising “show and tell”
10	Show and Tell	days/day-10-show-and-tell.md	Each child presents

Pacing notes

- Sessions are 30 minutes, not 45.
- Day 7's safety lesson is the most important non-fun moment. Be firm, then move on.
- Project work fits in Days 8 and 9. Day 10 is presentation only.

Running theme

Open every class with: **“Did you see the Moon last night? What shape was it?”** Two children share.

What children leave with

- A 10-night moon diary (with simple sketches)
- A sticker-Moon calendar poster
- Two Sanskrit words they say correctly: *amāvasyā* and *pūrṇimā*
- A torch-and-ball memory of why the Moon changes shape
- The habit of looking up

Homework

Homework — Moon Phases and Tithi (Primary)

Light daily tasks. Each takes 5–10 minutes.

1. **Day 1 — The Moon and Its Shapes** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
2. **Day 2 — Two Fortnights — Pakṣa** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
3. **Day 3 — Fifteen Tithis per Pakṣa** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
4. **Day 4 — Building a Tithi Calendar** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
5. **Day 5 — Lunar Months and Festivals** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
6. **Day 6 — Panchanga — Five Limbs** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
7. **Day 7 — Why Eclipses Happen** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
8. **Day 8 — Modern Lunar Science** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
9. **Day 9 — Cross-cultural Calendars** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
10. **Day 10 — Synthesis and Quiz** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)

Notes

- Homework is intended to consolidate what was learned in class, not introduce new content.
- If a child struggles, the parent should consult the teacher rather than push.
- Capstone project days (Module 15) may have lighter daily homework so students can focus on the project.